

volunteers, rather than draftees, to sign up. According to the Enrollment Act, if a particular district or city was able to supply a certain number of volunteers, it no longer had to enact the draft.

A number of communities offered generous “bounties”—monetary incentives—to entice volunteers and thus, they hoped, to avoid the need for conscription. A lively criminal practice started, in which men signed up for a particular district or regiment, received the bounty, then “jumped” to another geographic area, where they repeated the process. Small fortunes were illicitly amassed in this way, and many bounty-jumpers were never caught.

In a letter of January 1863, Major Charles Fessenden Morse of the 2nd Massachusetts Infantry wrote of the apathy in the North in the war’s middle period: “What we need is to feel that we are fighting for our lives and liberties; that is the way the Rebels feel ... Our people seem to be in an indifferent state.” Civilian war weariness and lack of interest were increasingly among President Lincoln’s greatest enemies.